

applications like Dall-e and AI-based text-to-video generation apps like Imagen Video may see an uptick.

## Apple iPhone 15 series

One of the first new things that will happen in the 'New Year' is the launch of the iPhone 15. Now, Apple launches a new handset every year so what is so new about this one?

Well, firstly this may be the first iPhone ever to come with a USB-C port in place of the lightning port that Apple used otherwise. It seems like Apple has no option but to do this in light of the latest European Union law about all devices to come with a USB-C port. This law was passed in October this year to reduce electronic waste generated.

This speculation was also confirmed by the company's marketing lead, Greg Joswaik who said that 'The company has no option but to shift to the USB-C port'.

Joswaik also piqued interest when he did not respond to an interviewer's ques-



tion about if an iPhone will be launched with a USB-C port in all markets or not. This gives rise to the speculation that the change may only come in the European markets and no other market.

There is another speculation about Apple that may be proved right/wrong in the iPhone 15 and that is about how they may decide to go portless which means there will be no port for anything at all. Now what would be interesting to see, should that come to fruition is how people who use devices across various platforms may deal with this change.

## Digital Twins

Digital Twins is one of the lesser-known technologies on this list but could be something that industries would benefit from. For the unversed, they are digital replicas of physical systems, processes or in some cases objects that are used for motives like:

- Make more accurate products.
- Predict possible errors in the product or in some cases even reducing the cost of making such a product.
- Testing and stimulation to understand whether products function as per demand or not.

This technology could go a long way in optimising a product and also has the ability to change how business processes can be perfected and efficiency can be improved by such products. Their use-case could be heavy in industries like aeronautics, construction, education, healthcare and so on.

To understand how this technology works, let us take the example of a wind farm. It will be fitted with sensors in the vital areas of functionality and the sensors will be capable of producing different information about the wind farm. The data is then given to a processor that can then apply the same measurements to a digital copy to make it into an exact digital replica of the physical version itself. Because of the great advantage that they offer, their power is expected to be used to its full potential in the coming years to make the industries wherein it can be used much better in their productivity.

Countries are already adopting digital twins in a big way. There are two cities in the world that are Shanghai and Singapore that already have their own digital twins. Having this can help them in improving energy consumption, plan developments and even improvise traffic flow which is one of the major problems burdening developing/developed cities today.

## Superapps

A super-app is an application that provides end users with a set of core features along with access to mini-apps. It is built to portray a platform to deliver mini apps that the user can choose from to be used for a more personalised experience.

They work towards making the life of a consumer easier. How do they do that, one may ask? They provide apps like messaging and payment apps and a user can install chosen mini-apps on one app. Eventually, they are speculated to incorporate chatbots, IoT technologies and immersive experiences like the metaverse.

According to Gartner, there are 15 popular super apps that have been downloaded more than 4.6 billion times with more than 50% of them being active users. Even corporations like Walmart are using super-apps by consolidating all their apps in one place. Other than that there is also a fintech company by the name of Revolut that has a super-app for its banking service that already has 20 million users.

## Sustainable Technologies

In the world that we live in today, we are constantly threatened by environmental risks. It may be caused by CO2 emissions or e-waste generation, but the point is that there are a lot of these environmental concerns knocking on our door today. To deal with it, a lot of things are turning sustainable now and that includes various forms of technologies prevalent in the world today.

Sustainable technology is an umbrella term that has in it innovation that considers natural resources while not hampering the economic and social development it may contribute. It has within it two ideas, and technology that is made while keeping even one idea in mind is considered to be sustainable in nature. First, that which is designed to work towards making the condition of the environment or technology produced with the idea of sustainability in mind.

For example, if you happen to live in a metropolitan area in India, they are heavily adapting to electric buses which is a step forward in sustainable technologies.

From a business point-of-view, it is better to adapt to sustainable modes of technology. Firstly, it is better for your reputation because then you can showcase your company as an environment-friendly company and garner a lot of public support through that. Other than that, even long-term investors also may be keen to invest in a company that works using sustainable technologies.

Some other technologies worth keeping an eye on are:

- Cryptocurrency and Blockchain
- Web3 Internet
- NFT
- 5G
- IoT ■